TOPIC 4 · CREATE A PROFESSIONAL PRESENTATION WITH POWERPOINT COPILOT
LAB 9 THEME · DASHBOARD TO PRESENTATION

Lab 9 — Turn Dashboard Evidence into a Management Story

Maps to	LO4: turn verified dashboard evidence into a professional management presentation
Duration	30 minutes
Tools	Microsoft 365 Copilot · Excel · Word · PowerPoint · Outlook · OneDrive
Mock data	data/Northstar_Work_Orders.xlsx
Course	GenAI for Engineers · v2.3
Prompts	https://tertiarycourses.github.io/IES-GenAI-for-Engineers/prompts/#lab-9

Goal

Continue the baseline dashboard from Topic 3. Build a slide evidence register and a Word presentation brief before asking PowerPoint Copilot for an eight-slide management deck. The story connects work-order status, site backlog, service delivery and assignment proposals to a specific decision; it does not introduce unsupported savings or causes.

What You Will Do

Continue the baseline dashboard from Topic 3. Build a slide evidence register and a Word presentation brief before asking PowerPoint Copilot for an eight-slide management deck. The story connects work-order status, site backlog, service delivery and assignment proposals to a specific decision; it does not introduce unsupported savings or causes.

What You Will Build

Northstar_Presentation_Brief.docx, Northstar_Management_Draft.pptx and a slide-by-slide evidence register tied to the 120-row dashboard snapshot.

Prerequisites

- Microsoft 365 account with Copilot available in Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook. Availability depends on the assigned licence and tenant settings; confirm access with the trainer before class.
- Desktop Excel on Windows or Mac is recommended; save working copies to your assigned OneDrive course folder with AutoSave on. Do not overwrite the supplied input.
- Download this whole lab folder. All files are synthetic; work-genai is your own learner output folder.
- Verified Lab 8 baseline dashboard and frozen evidence snapshot.

Data note

Northstar Water Services is a fictional water-pipe maintenance and service company. All service hubs, staff and work orders are synthetic. Use the fixed reporting date 2026-09-30; missing facts remain UNKNOWN. Proposals do not change real assignments. Training email drafts are never sent.

Steps

Step 1. Open the untouched baseline Northstar_Dashboard.xlsx from Lab 8; confirm All selectors, total120 and report date2026-09-30. Do not use the 122-row sandbox. If needed use this lab's checkpoint and record rejoin. Record verified metric/chart values in the Evidence_Log sheet with source sheet/table, scope and date.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
EXCEL - CHAT ONLY:
For the untouched 120-row Northstar Water Services baseline dashboard at 2026-09-30, All
selectors, return a presentation evidence table: six KPIs, backlog by site, status and
job-category counts, unassigned backlog and relevant source references. Do not use the
refresh-test copy or infer service disruption, safety risk, causes or savings.
```

Step 2. Open data/templates/Northstar_Presentation_Brief_Template.docx in Word. Add the verified summary and chart values plus the OneDrive workbook link. Save as Northstar_Presentation_Brief.docx. Copilot must see selected files or pasted evidence; the link alone and the Excel conversation do not guarantee accessible context.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
WORD COPILOT:
Using this verified 120-row Northstar maintenance snapshot, draft an eight-slide management
presentation brief. For each slide give one claim headline, supporting measure/chart,
source/date/scope, limitation and speaker note. Structure: overview, portfolio, site backlog,
status/category mix, SLA/overdue, assignment/capacity, proposed actions/trade-offs,
decision/next review. Do not invent causes, savings, approval or future dates; use UNKNOWN
when absent.
```

Step 3. Review the brief against source values. A bar showing counts by site is not a severity index; if you want backlog by site, count only nonterminal statuses. Correct any misleading headline and fill the slide evidence register. Suggested actions must cite a finding and say proposed.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
WORD COPILOT:
Review this eight-slide Northstar Water Services brief against the supplied baseline evidence.
Check each headline has a supporting value, correct units, source/date/scope and an explicit
limitation. Rewrite unsupported claims as questions or proposed actions. Do not change
verified figures or invent approvals.
```

Step 4. Open the supplied PowerPoint template, save as Northstar_Management_Draft.pptx and open Copilot. Choose Create presentation from file if offered, or reference the Word brief while editing the existing deck. Select your reviewed OneDrive Word brief; direct workbook-to-deck creation is not assumed. Invoke @maintenance-reporting if available.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
POWERPOINT COPILOT:
@maintenance-reporting Create or update an eight-slide management presentation from the
selected Northstar_Presentation_Brief.docx. Follow the existing white/navy/blue template. One
evidence-based message per slide, short visible text, charts or tables for numerical evidence,
source/as-at/scope in notes, and a final decision request. Keep values exact, and label all
next actions as proposed. Do not add extra slides or invented facts.
```

Step 5. Replace approximate or invented charts with your reviewed Excel charts: copy chart in Excel, then PowerPoint Home > Paste > Paste Special > Microsoft Excel Chart Object for an editable embedded chart when supported; otherwise paste a static image and label it snapshot. Embedded copies and images do not automatically follow the original workbook. Use direct verified values if a chart object is unsupported.

Step 6. Inspect all eight slides and notes. Check chart title, axis, unit, status definition, date and scope. Each numeric headline must match one register row. Confirm the deck uses baseline120, not refresh122. Save for Lab 10; do not represent the draft as an approved plan.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
POWERPOINT COPILOT:
Audit the eight-slide Northstar Water Services management draft against the selected
presentation brief and evidence register. Confirm baseline 120, source notes, chart labels and
units, correct backlog exclusions and proposed-action wording. List needed corrections and
preserve slide count; do not claim Excel charts update automatically.
```

Sample Prompts

Use the app labelled for each prompt (or adapt it). Name the table and columns, state the output, and always verify the result. Use the linked prompts web page for one-click Copy buttons.

Copy-ready prompts: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/IES-GenAI-for-Engineers/prompts/#lab-9

#	Purpose	Prompt
1	Scope	State actual source, report date and selected scope before acting.
2	Verify	Explain the source/formula checks and preserve unknowns and original records.

Test It

Check	Expected result
Evidence continuity	Every deck figure maps to the 120-row Lab 8 baseline and slide evidence register.
Eight-slide narrative	Observation -> implication -> proposed action -> decision; no invented cause/savings.
Chart semantics	Backlog charts exclude Closed/Cancelled; embedded/image copies labelled snapshot.

Checkpoint

If you fell behind, use data/checkpoints/Northstar_Verified_Checkpoint.xlsx and data/checkpoints/Northstar_Verified_Snapshot.docx. Record checkpoint used in Prompt_Log; then perform this lab, rather than claiming the checkpoint as your output.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
Copilot cannot find the source	Use the app file picker to select the actual OneDrive file. A typed local path or a different app chat is not shared context. If needed copy only the verified snapshot into the current app.
A total disagrees with Control	Clear dashboard filters to All, check table extent and duplicate IDs, recalculate, then compare definitions and reporting date. Reconcile before continuing.
The named feature is missing	Confirm the correct assigned account, English display language and app version. Use the stated manual practice route; record feature unavailable. This is not evidence that a native skill ran.

Challenge

Repeat the task for one different site and explain how the filter scope changes the result. Keep the original verified output.

Reflection

Which evidence proves the output is correct, and which decision still needs a person?